4.2 The Atlantic Ocean

The Atlantic Ocean is the second largest ocean on Earth. It covers one sixth of the Earth's total area and spreads for about 85.13 million sq.km . It is bounded by North America and South America in the west and Europe and Africa in the east. Like the Pacific, it stretches from the Arctic Ocean in the north to the Southern Ocean in the south. The shape of the Atlantic Ocean resembles the letter **'S'**. The Strait of Gibraltar connects the Atlantic Ocean with the Mediterranean Sea. The Atlantic Ocean is the busiest



Atlantic Ocean and its Marginal Seas

shipping route between the Eastern and Western hemispheres. The deepest point is the **Milwaukee Deep** in the **Puerto Rica Trench**. It has a depth of about 8600 m^{-}. The Caribbean Sea, the Gulf of Mexico, the North Sea, the Gulf of Guinea and the Mediterranean Sea are important marginal seas of the Atlantic Ocean. St. Helena, Newfoundland, Iceland and Falkland are some of the islands found in this ocean.

HOTS: Why are the Red Sea, Dead Sea and Black Sea named so?

4.3 The Indian Ocean

The Indian Ocean is the third largest ocean on the Earth's surface. It covers an area of about 70.56 million sq.km. It is named after India. It is triangular in shape and bounded by Africa in the west, Asia in the north and Australia in the east. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep, Maldives, Sri Lanka, Mauritius and the Reunion Islands are some of the islands located in the Indian Ocean. Malacca strait connects the Indian Ocean and the Pacific Ocean.

Palk Strait connects the Bay of Bengal and Palk Bay.

The Bay of Bengal, the Arabian Sea, the Persian Gulf and the Red Sea are some of the important marginal seas of the Indian Ocean. The **Java trench** (7,725 m^{-}) is the deepest point in the Indian Ocean.



Indian Ocean and its Marginal Seas